

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Pascua, Diana KC S.
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	Bytemancy1
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	8/16/26
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

This challenge connected me to a raw TCP service over netcat instead of giving me a file to inspect. Once connected, the service printed a banner and then a single instruction: send it the character represented by ASCII decimal value 101, repeated 1751 times, all stuck together with no spaces in between. Nothing else was asked of me — the whole challenge was just correctly decoding and formatting that one line.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

The category was obvious as soon as I connected: this wasn't a file to analyze but a live prompt I had to answer correctly, so the "first look" here was just reading what the server said rather than running file or strings on anything. The instruction ("Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101 1751 times, side-by-side, no space") told me exactly two things I needed to figure out: what character decimal 101 maps to in ASCII, and how to generate a very long, unbroken run of that character instead of typing it out by hand.

3. Tools and Commands Used

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
<code>nc foggy-cliff.picoctf.net 58041</code>	Connect to the challenge service.	Got a banner and the instruction: "Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101 1751 times, side-by-side, no space."
ASCII table lookup	Figure out what character decimal 101 actually is.	101 = lowercase 'e'.
<code>python3 -c "print('e'*1751, end=")"</code>	Generate exactly 1751 e's with no separators, since typing that by hand wasn't realistic.	A single unbroken string of 1751 e's, ready to paste into the netcat session.
(pasted the string into nc)	Send the answer back to the server.	Server accepted it and printed the flag: picoCTF{....}.

Step 1

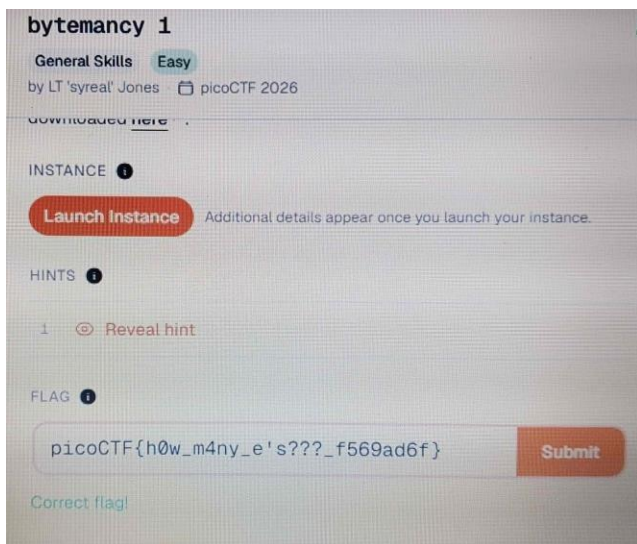
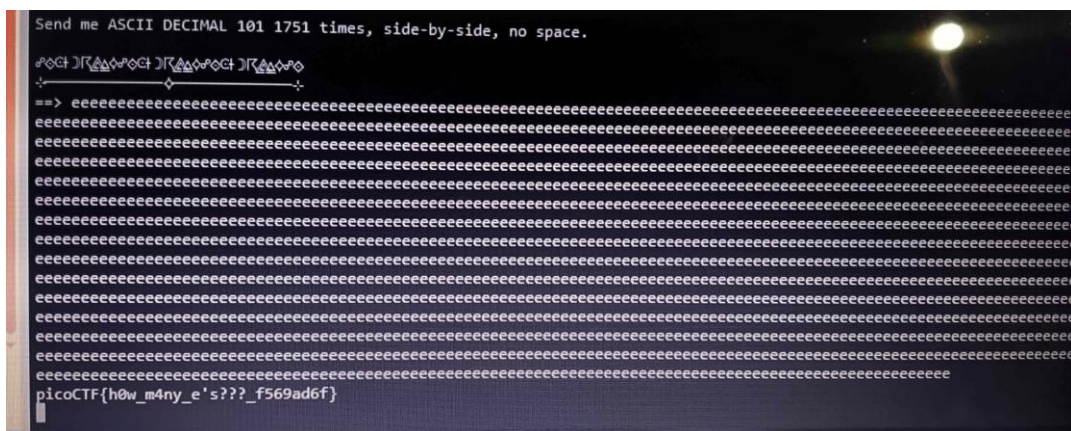
I ran nc.foggy-cliff.picoctf.net 58041 and got a small ASCII-art banner labeled "BYTEMANCY-1," followed by the actual task: send ASCII decimal 101, 1751 times, side-by-side, with no space between repetitions.



Decimal 101 on the ASCII table corresponds to the lowercase letter 'e'. So the real request, once translated, was: send the string "e" repeated 1751 times as one continuous block of text.

1751 characters is way too many to type by hand without a mistake, so I used a one-line Python command, `python3 -c "print('e'*1751, end='')"` , to build the exact string. Multiplying a string by an integer in Python repeats it that many times, and `end=""` stopped Python from adding an extra newline that could have counted as a stray "space" and broken the strict no-space requirement.

I pasted the generated block of 1751 e's straight into the still-open netcat session and hit enter. The server read it, confirmed the count and character were exactly right, and printed the flag directly below my input: `picoCTF{h0w m4ny e's??? f569ad6f}`.



5. Flag

picoCTF{h0w_m4ny_e's???_f569ad6f}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

The core idea here is basic ASCII encoding — knowing that every printable character maps to a specific decimal number, and being comfortable converting between the two. It's also a small lesson in automation: once a task involves generating large, precise, repetitive input, scripting it (even with a one-liner) is far more reliable than trying to do it manually, and it avoids exactly the kind of off-by-one or stray-whitespace mistake this challenge was designed to catch.

7. References

An ASCII table (e.g. asciitable.com) consulted to confirm that decimal 101 corresponds to the lowercase letter 'e'.
